MOUNTAIN REVIEW

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Volume V | Issue 1 | Winter 2015



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Winter Snapshots



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Post-War MV Images Needed

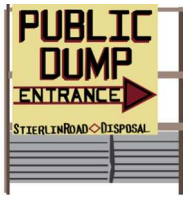


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2015 MVHA Calendar

NORTH BAYSHORE
Historical Facts & Figures



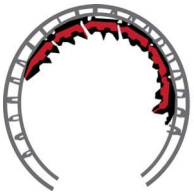
The c. 1867 Rengstorff House is the oldest structure still standing in Mtn. View.



Public dumps, the City landfill, and a hog farm once occupied what is now Shoreline Park.



Whisman School was located on Stierlin Road from 1869 to 1961.



The modern looped roller coaster was invented by Arrow Development, which was located in the North Bayshore until 1984.



The Century Theatres were built on the site of the Moffett Drive-In.



WINTER EVENT & MEMBERSHIP MEETING:

WHEN SHORELINE WAS STIERLIN

Memories of the North Bayshore

Today it is famed as a place where our high tech future is invented, but not so long ago, Mountain View's North Bayshore area was a time warp to the past. Until the 1980s, a drive north on Stierlin Road over the Bayshore Highway brought you to Mountain View's last rural neighborhood - home to farms, dairies, dilapidated homes of old pioneers, a drive-in theatre, a roller coaster plant, and the city dumps. Only traces of this history can be found today - but the memories remain! So please join us as we convene a panel discussion with former North Bayshore residents, workers, and planners who will share their stories about what life was like in Mtn. View's "final frontier."

FREE PUBLIC EVENT - FEB. 22, 2015 - 1PM - ADOBE BUILDING - 157 MOFFETT BLVD.



MOUNTAIN REVIEW

This newsletter is published four times a year by the
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

BOARD MEMBERS & CHAIRS

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Secretary: Jamil Shaikh
Treasurer: John Figueroa
Past President: Bob Weaver
Historical Data: Eugene Sharp
Membership: June Casey
Newsletter Editor: Nick Perry
Ways & Means: Richard Espinosa
Director-at-Large: Nick Galiotto
Director-at-Large: Lisa Roquero Garcia
Hospitality: Helene Hughes
Programs: Bob Weaver
Publicity: Mary Kay Marinovich

In Memoriam

Ernest "Ernie" Gamma, Sr.
Jan. 6, 1926 - Dec. 29, 2014

Margaret Garliepp Sideroff
Oct. 29, 1923 - Sept. 29, 2014

News & Notes

President's Message

By Patricia Figueroa
MVHA President

Happy New Year Everyone! The MVHA Board has been busy planning another great year for our organization. First matter of business was formally approving our 2015 Board of Directors. In 2014 we said farewell to Cliff Del Carlo, our past Vice-President. He was an active and productive Board Member, and we are pleased that he has assured us that he will still help whenever he can. The Board also said goodbye to Barbara Kinchen after she retired from decades of dedicated service. We thank Eugene Sharp for taking on her most recent position as our Historical Data Chair.

New to the Board is Vice-President Candace Bowers, Director-at-Large Lisa Garcia, and Publicity Chair Mary Kay Marinovich. We are very excited to have them join us! A special thank you to the Board Members and Committee Chairs that agreed to serve for a new term. Your continued support of the Association is very appreciated.

Looking forward to 2015 and beyond, we plan to build off the momentum of the past few years. Membership is up (thank you all!) and we hope to continue to welcome new members and build stronger ties to the larger Mountain View community. Thanks to those of you who filled out our recent membership survey. Your input is helping us plan the future of the organization. If you haven't filled out the survey and would like to offer your input - please don't hesitate to contact us with your ideas!

We have a variety of projects we hope to participate in this year - such as the new Veterans Memorial at Eagle Park and exploring opportunities to install new interpretive plaques at historic sites around Mountain View. We're also planning a great line-up of events, starting on February 22 with our panel on one of Mountain View's most fascinating areas - the North Bayshore. Note that the event has moved off the traditional "1st Sunday of the Month" schedule so as to not conflict with the Super Bowl. This will be especially helpful next year, when the game takes place at Levi's Stadium.

We're excited to announce that our Spring event on May 3 will take place at the historic Wunderman House on Eunice Avenue, a Prohibition-era speakeasy! Stay tuned for more details in our next newsletter. Our Summer event will return to the Adobe, where you'll be pleased to know that Linda's burgers will return to the menu!

Finally, we are looking for volunteers to help us represent the organization and share Mountain View history with the community. The most immediate needs are the following:

Spring Parade (April 25): Eugene Sharp has offered the use of one of his beautiful classic automobiles. We need a few volunteers to help with set-up and to ride with Eugene in the car. If we have enough volunteers, we might also staff an info table at the post-parade event at Pioneer Park.

Thursday Night Live (Dates TBD): We are also exploring participating in the summer "Thursday Night Live"on Castro Street.

Please let me know if can help us with some volunteer time. My e-mail is: patfig@ix.netcom.com. Looking forward to a fun and active year!

Financial Report

By John Figueroa
Treasurer

Checking Account Balance as of 9/3/14: $ 5,725.94
- Income: $1,137.16
- Expenses: $1,926.53

Checking Account Balance as of 12/10/14: $ 4,936.57

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 9/3/14: $83,045.85
Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 12/10/14: $83,137.44

History Center Update

By Candace Bowers
MVHA Vice President

From Newsletter Editor Nick Perry: NASA Ames Research Center 75th Anniversary commemorative booklet. Aerial photo of the San Antonio Road area on Christmas Eve 1974 (Digital version shared on our facebook page on Christmas Eve, 40 years later to-the-day!).

From Member Rose Lesslie: Information on Mountain View High School alumni who were killed in action during World War II. Ms. Lesslie has done extensive research on their service records and place of burial overseas.

From our November Guest Speaker, Jack Boyd: A book on the history of NASA Ames Research Center.



The History Center

Mountain View Public Library, 2nd Floor
585 Franklin Street, Mtn. View, CA 94041

Open from 1-5pm every Tuesday & by appointment.
Call 650-903-6890 for more information.

The Mtn. History Center's mission is to collect, organize and make available Mountain View historical resources and to promote the city's heritage. It contains the historic archives of both the MVHA and the Mtn. View Public Library. Mtn. View history books and pamphlets are also available for purchase at the History Center.

Meet the New MVHA Board Members!

As we begin 2015, the MVHA is very excited to welcome three new faces to our Board of Directors! Learn a bit about each of them here.

Candace Bowers

MVHA Vice President



Candace Bowers has worked at the Mountain View Public Library for 24 years, at the adult reference desk and more recently in the Mountain View History Center. She is a Bay Area native and a 2008 graduate of Leadership Mountain View. She enjoys taking students on tours of the History Center, and leading craft workshops for adults.

Mary Kay "Marina" Marinovich

MVHA Publicity Chair



Mary Kay "Marina" Marinovich is a Mountain View native who grew up on an apricot/ cherry orchard at Grant Road and Oak Avenue. She is the daughter of a Croatian immigrant and lived in a time when apricots were once more plentiful than silicon chips. She is a lead advocate for the saving of Immigrant House (see article on Page 4); a project she hopes will become a historic display in the new park at 771 N. Rengstorff Avenue and will be a tribute to Mountain View's agrarian past and immigrant laborers. She currently serves on the Board of the Mountain View Kiwanis Club and is Old Mountain View Neighborhood Association Historic Sub Committee Chair. Preserving our history, our native wildlife and our heritage tree canopy are causes that are dear to her heart.

Lisa Roquero Garcia

MVHA Director-at-Large



Lisa Roquero Garcia is a life-long resident of Mountain View. She is part of the third-generation of her family to call the city home. Her mother's side has deep roots in the city's Mexican American community, her father's side in the city's Filipino American community. An alumnus of Los Altos High (Eagles) and the University of California, Berkeley, Lisa works as a business systems analysis for Intuit. She is the proud mother of two children, both current students at Mtn. View High. She is excited to join the MVHA Board and help share Mountain View's rich and diverse history with the community.

Immigrant House Update

By Mary Kay "Marina" Marinovich
Publicity Chair

Editors Note: *Marina Marinovich is leading efforts to restore the "Immigrant House" which stood behind the historic Pearson House at 902 Villa Street (dem. in 2013). Here, Marina offers an update on the future of the Immigrant House.*

It's official! Immigrant House is to be incorporated into the design of Mountain View's newest park. The Old Mountain View neighborhood's 1880s historic little laborer's house has been saved and will be included in the design of the 1.22 acre park at 771 North Rengstorff Ave. On December 9, the City Council approved a staff recommendation for Callander and Associates Inc. to provide design services for the park in the amount not to exceed $168,100. This group has worked with several cities on very successful park projects, which include moving the Neutra House in Los Altos, and designing both the Stojanovich Family Park in Campbell as well as the J. Neely Johnson Community Garden in Sacramento.

Once Immigrant House has been renovated and relocated to the new park, it will stand as a humble remnant of Old Mountain View's pioneer past. It is to be hoped that the property will remain as undisturbed and natural as possible as it is a jewel of a site, reminding Mountain View residents of the city's agrarian roots. The park will also provide indigenous wildlife a sanctuary, something hard to come by in the very busy North Rengstorff area. Important as well, is that the preserved little house itself will be educational for future generations.

Structurally, Immigrant House incorporates building techniques that have not been seen in more than 100 years. It also exemplifies the difficult living conditions that immigrants endured while trying to improve their lives in America. It is probably the oldest surviving home in Mountain View, and the last remaining laborer's cottage in Santa Clara Valley. That it lasted in the downtown Mountain View neighborhood until 2012 is a miracle unto itself! Its tenants and those of others like it built the infrastructure that made Mountain View what it is today.

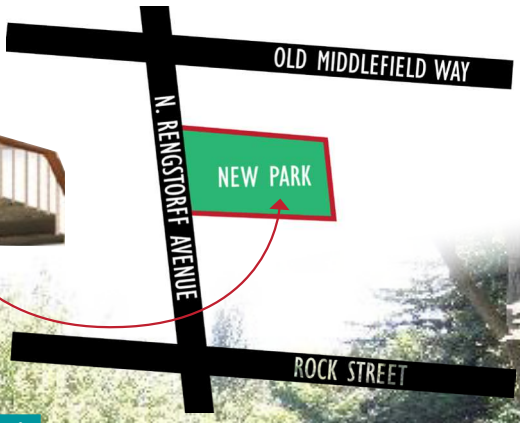
Prospective donors are expressing interest in the use of the structure, which will be determined during the design of the park. The Friends of Immigrant House hope to exhibit the house as a static display. To this end, they have been given a nine month extension to raise funds equaling $113,500. $55,000 has been raised so far. Appealing to donors to raise the remaining $58,500 will be easier now that a design plan offering specifics is on its way, thanks to the City Council's staff recommendation approval.

The other structure which is currently located on the park is the original Stieper home, built in the 1950s by the Stiepers themselves. Building one's own home was very common during that era. Historically, the home is a part of the property's story. It dates back just prior to the suburbanization that replaced all the orchards and dairies of the area. Modern historians now say there is an alarming tendency to destroy structures built in the 50s and 60s, much the way many Victorians were torn down during the 20s and 30s. If a supported use for the structure can be found, there is the possibility it will not be destroyed.

So what are your thoughts? Keep the original home built by the Stiepers and turn it to a garden gift shop like the Allied Arts Guild of Menlo Park, a museum, a meeting area for clubs, a place for knitting groups and arts and crafts enthusiasts to gather? Or how about a new Mountain View Gardening Club, or maybe even a history museum? Conversely, because of its close proximity to the road, the home could be demolished in order to create an area for busses to pull into in order to facilitate visits to the park by school children. This is everyone's new park, so please give the city your input; they are open to your ideas and want to listen.

Want to learn more? E-mail Marina at mkm@bi0s.com







Marina Marinovich (left) and Francis Stieper (right) on the Stieper family property - future park and home of the Immigrant House.

STIEPER FAMILY PROPERTY

Winter 2014 Snapshots



At our Winter Event and Membership Meeting the MVHA welcomed Jack Boyd from NASA Ames Research Center as our special guest speaker. The event was themed to NASA Ames's 75th anniversary. As always, our Hospitality Chair Helene Hughes did a fantastic job decorating the Adobe - this time with a space travel theme! Mr. Boyd gave a very fascinating slide show presentation on the rich history of NASA Ames. Those in attendance left impressed that we have such a stellar landmark right in our own backyard.



On November 14 Candace Bowers and Nick Perry gave a presentation on Mountain View history to the Chamber of Commerce's Leadership Mountain View class. Feedback from attendees was very positive, and the MVHA and Leadership MV hope to make this an annual collaboration!

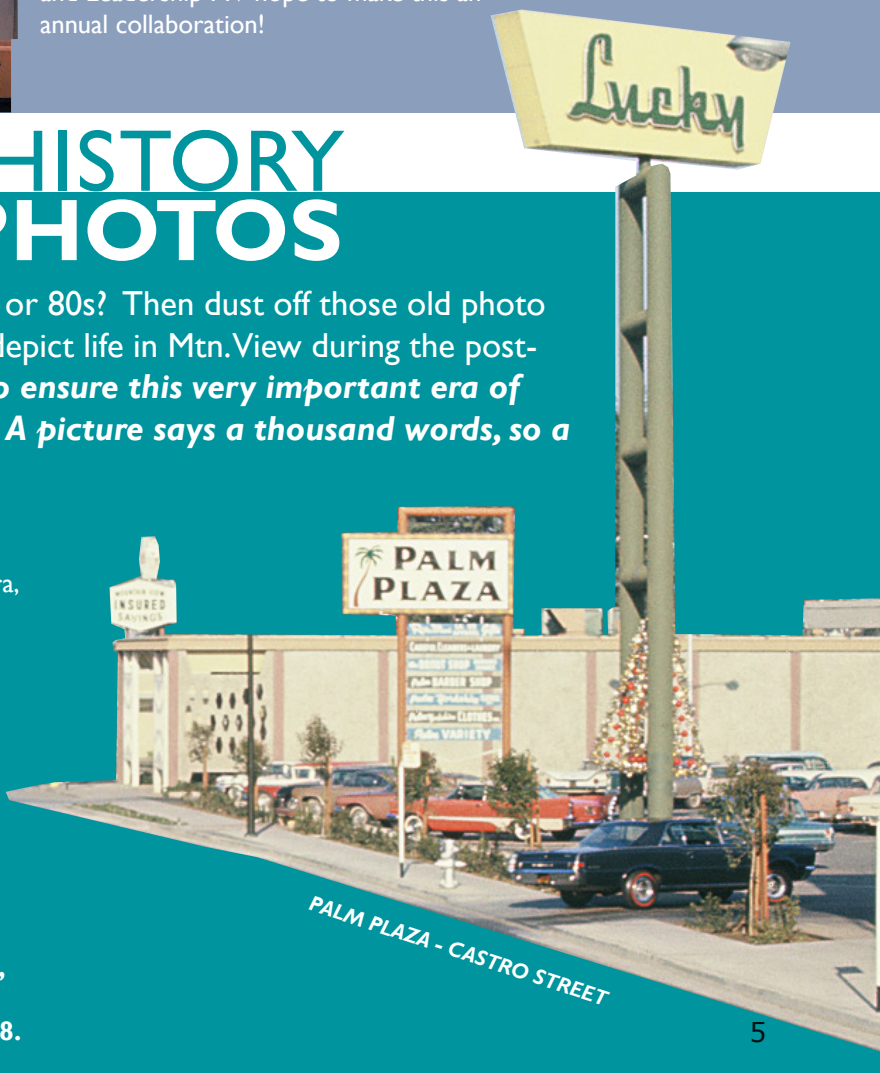
PRESERVE OUR HISTORY
SHARE YOUR PHOTOS

Did you live in Mtn. View in the 1950s, 60s, 70s or 80s? Then dust off those old photo albums! The MVHA is looking for images that depict life in Mtn. View during the post-World War II boom-years. ***Now is the time to ensure this very important era of Mtn. View's history is properly documented. A picture says a thousand words, so a robust photographic archive is key!***

Building Our Archive

Our archive could use more images from the Post-War era, color images especially (but black and white is fine too!). Take a look at the background of your old family photos - do they show Mtn. View locales or landscapes? Then your image might be a good candidate for our archive. It might even be included in a new book on Modern Mtn. View history!

We realize images are often precious keepsakes, and you may not want to part ways with them. We can scan and return any images sent via mail. If you live in the Bay Area, we can arrange to come to you and create digital copies on site. **If you think you might have images to share, please e-mail our newsletter editor, Nick Perry, at mvha.newsletter@gmail.com or call (650) 722 2588.**



MVHA 2015 Calendar



CASTRO STREET AND VILLA STREET C. 1915

January

Happy New Year!

If you're interested in volunteering with the MVHA at any of our 2015 events e-mail: patfig@ix.netcom.com

February

February 22*
*Note later date!
MVHA Winter Event & Meeting
Adobe Building - 1pm

I ♥ MV

March

March 11
MVHA Board Meeting
Mtn.View History Center - 6PM
March 27
Spring Newsletter Deadline

April

April 25
MVHA at the Downtown Spring Parade
Castro Street - 12pm - 3pm
MVHA Volunteers needed!

May

May 3
MVHA Spring Event & Meeting
Wunderman House, 655 Eunice Avenue - 1pm

June

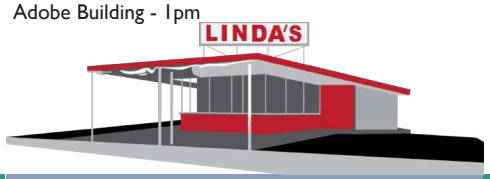
June 10
MVHA Board Meeting
Location TBA - 6PM
June 26
Summer Newsletter Deadline

July

July 9 and/or July 23
MVHA at Thursday Night Live
Castro Street - 5:30pm - 8:30pm
MVHA Volunteers needed!

August

August 2
MVHA Summer BBQ & Meeting
Adobe Building - 1pm



September

September 9
MVHA Board Meeting
Location TBA - 6PM

September 25
Fall Newsletter Deadline

October

October 3
Mtn.View Union High School
Eagle Alumni Picnic
Location & Time TBA



November

November 7
City of Mtn.View's 113th Birthday!

November 8
MVHA Fall Event & Meeting
Adobe Building - 1pm

December

December 9
MVHA Board Meeting
Location TBA - 6PM

TBA
Mtn.View Holiday Tree Lighting
Civic Center Plaza - 500 Castro Street

Membership

Membership Report

By June Casey
Membership Chair

Membership as of December 19, 2014

Honored Members	2
Life Members	115
Family Members	78
Single Members	115
TOTAL MEMBERSHIP	**311**

New Life Member: Lucas Ramirez
New Members: David T. Atkins Family, Candace Bowers, Elaine Luiz Jae, Carrie Warren.

Join us today!

The Mountain View Historical Association welcomes new members. Any person who signifies interest in the aims of the Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member.

The aims of the MVHA are:

- To gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View.
- To collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area
- To preserve historic objects and places
- To cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership

Thank you and a warm welcome to our new members!



RENEW TODAY

If you had Annual Membership in 2014, we hope you'll join us again in 2015. Dues are tax deductible to the extent allowed by law. Your support is appreciated!

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Membership Application & Renewal Form

- ☐ New membership
- ☐ Renewal
- ☐ REGULAR MEMBER: *$15/year*
- ☐ FAMILY MEMBER: *$25/year*
- ☐ LIFE TIME MEMBER: *$200*
- ☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

CITY: _____

STATE: _____ ZIP: _____

TELEPHONE: _____

E-MAIL: _____

Please make checks payable to:
Mountain View Historical Association

Mail to:
Mountain View Historical Association
PO Box 252, Mountain View, Ca 94042

WINTER/SPRING

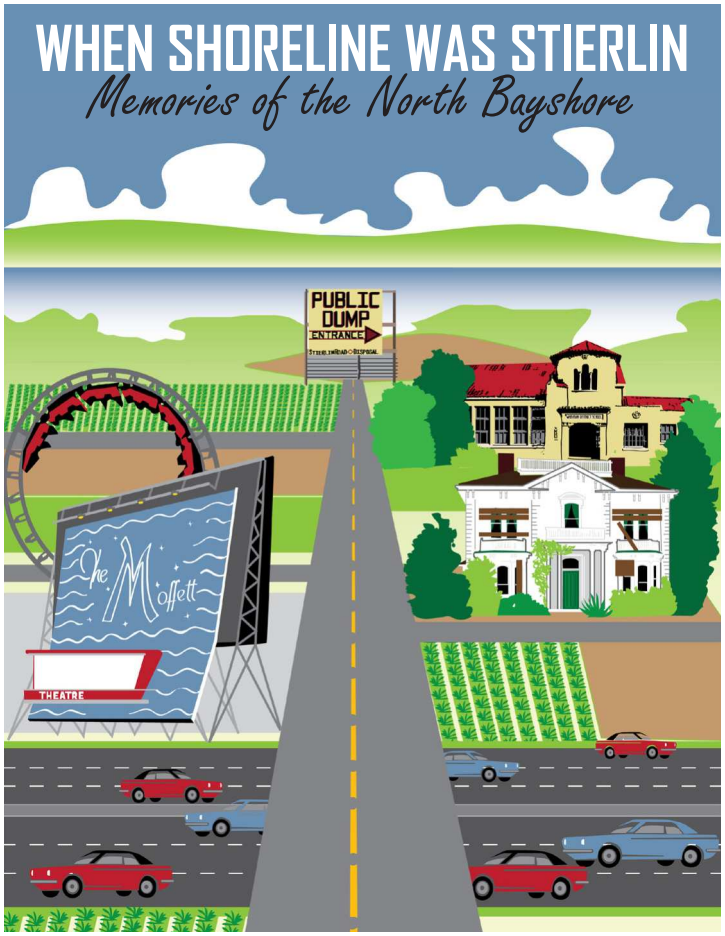
February 22
Sunday, 1:00-2:30 pm
MVHA Winter Event/Meeting
Adobe Building - 157 Moffett Blvd.
"When Shoreline was Stierlin" - Details on Page 1

March 11
Wednesday, 6:00 - 8:00 pm
MVHA Board Meeting
M.V. Library History Center - 585 Franklin St.
Interested members welcome to attend!

March 27
Spring Newsletter Deadline
Submissions welcome!
E-mail mvha.newsletter@gmail.com

April 25
Saturday, 12pm-3pm
Downtown Spring Parade
Castro Street - Downtown Mtn.View
MVHA volunteers needed!
E-mail patfig@ix.netcomom

MVHA Winter Event & Membership Meeting



EST. 1954
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MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042
WEB: www.mountainviewhistorical.org
E-MAIL: mvha.newsletter@gmail.com

Join us for another year of Mountain View history and renew your annual membership. Membership form on Page 7.

FIRST CLASS MAIL

Join the conversation on Facebook!
"Like" us at ***www.facebook.com/MVHistory*** for updates on MVHA Events, historic trivia, and to interact with other members on-line.

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